

WhatsApp Fruit & Veg Delivery Bot — Setup Guide

This bot connects to your WhatsApp Business Account and can:

- Show a menu (Order / FAQs / Talk to a person)
- Take full orders (catalog → quantities → address → date → confirm)
- Tag each order as Individual or Corporate
- Message YOU on WhatsApp with every order's full details
- Answer common questions automatically

No coding knowledge is needed after setup — just edit `products.json` and `faqs.json` in plain text when prices or questions change.

Part 1 — Connect to WhatsApp (Meta)

1. Go to **business.facebook.com** and make sure you have a Meta Business Account (create one if you don't).
2. Go to **developers.facebook.com** → My Apps → Create App → choose "Business" type.
3. In your new app, add the **WhatsApp** product.
4. Under WhatsApp → API Setup, you'll see:
 - A **temporary access token** (valid 24h — for testing only)
 - A **Phone Number ID**
 - A test phone number you can message from your own WhatsApp to test
5. To go live with your real business number, go to WhatsApp → Configuration and follow Meta's steps to add and verify your business phone number.
6. Generate a **permanent access token**: System Users (in Business Settings) → create a system user → assign it to your app → generate token with `whatsapp_business_messaging` permission. Save this token somewhere safe.

You now have: `WHATSAPP_TOKEN` and `PHONE_NUMBER_ID`.

Part 2 — Deploy the bot (Render.com, free/simple)

1. Create a free account at **render.com**.
2. Put this project folder into a GitHub repository (Render deploys from GitHub). If you don't have GitHub, create a free account at github.com, create a new repository, and upload these files.
3. In Render: New → Web Service → connect your GitHub repo.
4. Settings:
 - Build command: `npm install`
 - Start command: `npm start`
5. Add Environment Variables in Render's dashboard (Settings → Environment) using the values from `.env.example` :
 - `WHATSAPP_TOKEN`
 - `PHONE_NUMBER_ID`
 - `VERIFY_TOKEN` (make up any secret string, e.g. `mangobot2026`)
 - `OWNER_WHATSAPP_NUMBER` (your number, digits only, country code, no +)
 - `BUSINESS_NAME`
 - `CURRENCY`
6. Deploy. Render will give you a URL like `https://your-app-name.onrender.com` .

Part 3 — Connect the webhook

1. Back in Meta's developer portal → WhatsApp → Configuration → Webhook.
2. Callback URL: `https://your-app-name.onrender.com/webhook`
3. Verify token: the same `VERIFY_TOKEN` you set in Render.
4. Click Verify and Save.
5. Subscribe to the **messages** field.

Send a WhatsApp message to your business number — the bot should reply with the menu.

Editing your catalog or FAQs later

- Open `products.json` — each item has `id`, `name`, `unit`, `price`. Add, remove, or edit lines, keeping the same format.
- Open `faqs.json` — each entry has `keywords` (words that trigger it) and `answer`. Add as many as you like.
- After editing, push the change to GitHub — Render will auto-redeploy.

Notes & limitations

- Render's free tier can "sleep" after inactivity and take ~30 seconds to wake on the next message — fine for most small businesses, but if that's a problem, Render's cheapest paid tier (\$7/mo) keeps it always on.
- The bot currently handles one product at a time when building an order (pick item → quantity → repeat). This keeps it reliable within WhatsApp's message format; it can be extended later if you want a faster multi-item flow.
- All conversation state is saved to a file (`sessions.json`) so it survives restarts.
- Cash-on-delivery is the only payment method built in, matching your current setup.